

## # EYE

### ## 1. Passage anchor

> “She also had **\*\*a sharp eye for potential\*\***.”

#### ### Passage meaning

**\*\*eye\*\*** here does not simply mean the physical organ.

**\*\*have an eye for something\*\***

= have a natural ability to notice, recognize, judge, or appreciate something well

**\*\*對.....有眼光；善於看出.....；有鑑賞力\*\***

So:

**\*\*a sharp eye for potential\*\***

= a very good ability to recognize people's potential

**\*\*對他人的潛力有敏銳的眼光\*\***

#### ### Practice

1. She has **\*\*a good eye for talent\*\***.

她對人才很**\*\*有眼光\*\***。

2. A skilled photographer needs **\*\*an eye for detail\*\***.

優秀的攝影師需要有**\*\*觀察細節的眼光\*\***。

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## # Core meanings of EYE

### ## 2. eye — the organ used for seeing

= one of the two organs on the face that people and many animals use to see

**\*\*眼睛；眼\*\***

This is the central literal meaning.

#### ### Examples

1. She has blue **\*\*eyes\*\***.

她有一雙藍色的**\*\*眼睛\*\***。

2. Something got into my **\*\*eye\*\***.

有東西跑進我的**\*\*眼睛\*\***裡。

Common combinations:

- \* left eye 左眼
- \* right eye 右眼
- \* close your eyes 閉眼
- \* open your eyes 睜眼
- \* rub your eyes 揉眼睛

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### ## 3. eye — eyesight / ability to see

= the ability to see or visually distinguish things

**\*\*視力；眼力\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. His **\*\*eyes\*\*** are not as good as they used to be.  
他的**\*\*視力\*\***不如以前。
2. She has an excellent **\*\*eye\*\*** for small details.  
她有很好的**\*\*眼力\*\***，能注意到細節。

This sense often blends with perceptual ability.

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### ## 4. eye — look / gaze / visual attention

= the direction or focus of someone's looking

**\*\*目光；視線\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. His **\*\*eyes\*\*** moved toward the door.  
他的**\*\*目光\*\***移向門口。
2. She kept her **\*\*eyes\*\*** on the road.  
她一直把**\*\*視線\*\***放在路上。

Common expressions:

- \* catch someone's eye 引起某人的注意
- \* keep your eyes on something 注意 / 盯著
- \* take your eyes off something 把視線移開

\* all eyes on... 所有人的目光都集中在.....

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### ## 5. eye — attention

By extension from looking, \*\*eye\*\* can represent attention.

\*\*注意；關注\*\*

#### ### Examples

1. The unusual design immediately caught my \*\*eye\*\*.

那個不尋常的設計立刻\*\*吸引了我的注意\*\*。

2. The issue has attracted the public \*\*eye\*\*.

這個問題引起了公眾的\*\*關注\*\*。

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### # Perception and judgment

### ## 6. have an eye for something

= be good at noticing, judging, choosing, or appreciating something

\*\*對.....有眼光；善於辨別 / 發現.....\*\*

This is one of the most important figurative meanings.

#### ### Examples

1. He has \*\*an eye for quality\*\*.

他對品質很\*\*有眼光\*\*。

2. She has \*\*an eye for promising young artists\*\*.

她很善於\*\*發掘有潛力的年輕藝術家\*\*。

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### ## 7. eye for detail

= ability to notice small or important details

\*\*注重細節的眼光；敏銳的細節觀察力\*\*

#### ### Examples

1. Good editors need **\*\*an eye for detail\*\***.

優秀的編輯需要有**\*\*敏銳的細節觀察力\*\***。

2. Her **\*\*eye for detail\*\*** makes her an excellent designer.

她對細節的**\*\*敏銳眼光\*\***使她成為出色的設計師。

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### ## 8. eye for beauty / design / colour

= ability to recognize or appreciate aesthetic quality

**\*\*審美眼光；鑑賞力\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. He has **\*\*a good eye for colour\*\***.

他對色彩很**\*\*有眼光\*\***。

2. She clearly has **\*\*an eye for design\*\***.

她顯然很有**\*\*設計審美眼光\*\***。

This often means aesthetic judgment rather than mere visual perception.

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### ## 9. a critical / expert / trained eye

= a way of looking informed by experience, expertise, or judgment

**\*\*批判性的眼光；專業眼光；受過訓練的眼光\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. An expert **\*\*eye\*\*** can spot the difference immediately.

**\*\*專業的眼光\*\***可以立即看出差異。

2. She examined the painting with a critical **\*\*eye\*\***.

她以**\*\*批判性的眼光\*\***審視這幅畫。

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### # Watching and monitoring

### ## 10. keep an eye on someone / something

= watch, monitor, or take care of someone or something

**\*\*留意；照看；監視\*\***

### ### Examples

1. Could you \*\*keep an eye on my bag\*\* for a minute?  
你可以幫我\*\*看一下包包\*\*嗎？
2. Doctors are \*\*keeping an eye on\*\* his condition.  
醫生正在\*\*密切留意\*\*他的情況。

The exact Chinese varies:

- \* 照看
- \* 留意
- \* 監察
- \* 盯著

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### ## 11. have / keep one eye on something

= give part of your attention to something

\*\*一邊留意.....；同時注意.....\*\*

### ### Examples

1. She worked while \*\*keeping one eye on the children\*\*.  
她工作時也\*\*同時留意孩子們\*\*。
2. Investors are \*\*keeping one eye on interest rates\*\*.  
投資者也一直\*\*留意利率走勢\*\*。

Often figurative.

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### ## 12. keep an eye out for something

= watch carefully so that you notice something if it appears

\*\*留心尋找；注意是否出現\*\*

### ### Examples

1. \*\*Keep an eye out for\*\* the sign on your left.  
\*\*留意一下\*\*左邊的標誌。
2. I'll \*\*keep an eye out for\*\* job openings.

我會\*\*留意是否有職缺\*\*。

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# Attraction and notice

## 13. catch someone's eye

### A. attract visual attention

\*\*吸引某人的目光\*\*

1. A bright red coat \*\*caught my eye\*\*.  
一件鮮紅色外套\*\*吸引了我的目光\*\*。

### B. make eye contact with someone

\*\*與某人目光相接\*\*

2. I tried to \*\*catch the waiter's eye\*\*.  
我試著\*\*引起服務生注意 / 和他對上眼\*\*。

Context determines the meaning.

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## 14. eye-catching

= attractive or noticeable enough to attract attention

\*\*醒目的；引人注目的\*\*

### Examples

1. The poster has an \*\*eye-catching design\*\*.  
這張海報的設計很\*\*醒目\*\*。

2. She wore an \*\*eye-catching red jacket\*\*.  
她穿了一件\*\*非常搶眼的紅色外套\*\*。

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# Looking at someone

## 15. eye — verb: look at carefully

\*\*eye + person / thing\*\*

= look at someone or something carefully, often with interest, suspicion, or desire

\*\*打量；注視；盯著看\*\*

### ### Examples

1. She \*\*eyed the cake\*\* suspiciously.

她帶著懷疑的神情\*\*看著那塊蛋糕\*\*。

2. The guard \*\*eyed us carefully\*\*.

警衛仔細地\*\*打量我們\*\*。

The verb often suggests more than neutral looking.

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### ## 16. eye someone suspiciously / cautiously

= look at someone with suspicion or caution

\*\*懷疑地打量；警惕地看著\*\*

### ### Examples

1. He \*\*eyed the stranger suspiciously\*\*.

他懷疑地\*\*打量那名陌生人\*\*。

2. The dog \*\*eyed me cautiously\*\*.

那隻狗警惕地\*\*盯著我看\*\*。

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### # Eye contact and expression

### ## 17. eye contact

= the state of two people looking directly into each other's eyes

\*\*眼神接觸；目光接觸\*\*

### ### Examples

1. Good speakers maintain \*\*eye contact\*\* with the audience.

優秀的演講者會與觀眾保持\*\*眼神接觸\*\*。

2. He avoided \*\*eye contact\*\* during the interview.

面試時他避免與人\*\*目光接觸\*\*。

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### ## 18. meet someone's eye / eyes

= look directly at someone who is looking at you

\*\*與某人目光相接；直視某人\*\*

#### ### Examples

1. She refused to \*\*meet his eye\*\*.

她拒絕\*\*與他對視\*\*。

2. Our \*\*eyes met\*\* across the room.

我們隔著房間\*\*目光相遇\*\*。

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### ## 19. look someone in the eye

= look directly into someone's eyes, often showing confidence or honesty

\*\*直視某人的眼睛\*\*

#### ### Examples

1. He couldn't \*\*look me in the eye\*\*.

他無法\*\*直視我的眼睛\*\*。

2. She \*\*looked him straight in the eye\*\* and answered.

她\*\*直視著他的眼睛\*\*回答。

Often associated with:

\* honesty

\* confidence

\* confrontation

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### # Perspective and viewpoint

### ## 20. in someone's eyes

= according to someone's opinion or judgment

\*\*在某人眼中；在某人看來\*\*

#### ### Examples

1. In her parents' **\*\*eyes\*\***, she was still a child.

**\*\*在她父母眼中\*\***，她仍然是個孩子。

2. His actions made him a hero in the public **\*\*eye\*\***.

他的行動使他**\*\*在公眾眼中\*\***成為英雄。

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### ## 21. through someone's eyes

= from someone's perspective or experience

**\*\*透過某人的眼光；從某人的角度\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. The story is told **\*\*through the eyes of a child\*\***.

這個故事是**\*\*從一個孩子的角度\*\***敘述的。

2. The documentary lets us see the city **\*\*through local eyes\*\***.

這部紀錄片讓我們能**\*\*從當地人的角度\*\***看這座城市。

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### ## 22. see something with fresh / new eyes

= see or reconsider something from a new perspective

**\*\*以新的眼光看待\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. Travelling helped me see my hometown **\*\*with fresh eyes\*\***.

旅行讓我能**\*\*以新的眼光\*\***看自己的家鄉。

2. After the discussion, I looked at the problem **\*\*with new eyes\*\***.

討論過後，我**\*\*以新的角度\*\***看待這個問題。

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### # Public visibility

### ## 23. the public eye

= public attention, awareness, or observation

**\*\*公眾視野；公眾關注\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. She has lived in the **\*\*public eye\*\*** for years.

她多年來一直生活在**\*\*公眾關注之下\*\***。

2. The scandal brought the company into the **\*\*public eye\*\***.

這場醜聞使這家公司進入**\*\*公眾視野\*\***。

Common:

\* be in the public eye 受到公眾關注

\* stay out of the public eye 避開公眾注意

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# Shape resemblance

## 24. eye — a small hole or opening

The physical shape of an eye gives rise to several object meanings.

### A. eye of a needle

= the small hole through which thread passes

**\*\*針眼\*\***

### Examples

1. Push the thread through the **\*\*eye of the needle\*\***.

把線穿過**\*\*針眼\*\***。

2. The needle has a very small **\*\*eye\*\***.

這根針的**\*\*針眼\*\***很小。

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## 25. eye — loop or ring used for fastening

= a small loop or hole into which a hook or other object fits

**\*\*環；扣眼；孔眼\*\***

### Examples

1. Fasten the hook through the **\*\*eye\*\***.

把鉤子扣進**\*\*環眼\*\***裡。

2. The dress has small hooks and **\*\*eyes\*\*** at the back.

這件洋裝背後有小鉤子和\*\*環扣\*\*。

Common in:

\* hook and eye

\* metal eye

\* fastening eye

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## 26. eye — small spot or mark resembling an eye

= a circular or oval mark resembling an eye

\*\*眼狀斑點；眼紋\*\*

### Examples

1. The butterfly has large \*\*eye spots\*\* on its wings.

那隻蝴蝶翅膀上有大型\*\*眼狀斑紋\*\*。

2. The feather has a colourful \*\*eye\*\* near the tip.

那根羽毛末端附近有一個彩色的\*\*眼狀斑點\*\*。

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# Weather

## 27. eye of a storm / hurricane / cyclone

= the relatively calm central part of a powerful tropical storm

\*\*颱風眼；風眼\*\*

### Examples

1. The \*\*eye of the hurricane\*\* passed directly over the island.

\*\*颱風眼\*\*直接穿過那座島。

2. Conditions became briefly calm as the \*\*eye\*\* passed overhead.

當\*\*風眼\*\*經過上空時，天氣短暫平靜下來。

This is a distinct established meteorological meaning.

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## 28. eye of the storm — figurative

= the centre of an intense controversy, crisis, or activity

**\*\*風暴中心；爭議核心\*\***

### ### Examples

1. The minister found himself at the **\*\*eye of the storm\*\***.

那位部長發現自己處於**\*\*爭議風暴的中心\*\***。

2. The company was suddenly in the **\*\*eye of the storm\*\***.

那家公司突然成為**\*\*事件的焦點\*\***。

This comes directly from the weather metaphor.

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## # Plants and food

### ## 29. eye of a potato

= a small bud on a potato from which a new shoot can grow

**\*\*馬鈴薯芽眼\*\***

### ### Examples

1. New shoots grow from the potato's **\*\*eyes\*\***.

新芽會從馬鈴薯的**\*\*芽眼\*\***長出來。

2. Cut away any damaged **\*\*eyes\*\*** before planting.

種植前把受損的**\*\*芽眼\*\***切掉。

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## # Photography and cameras

### ## 30. eye — camera-like viewpoint

In compounds and figurative use, **\*\*eye\*\*** may refer to visual observation or a viewing position.

Examples include:

\* camera eye

\* photographer's eye

\* bird's-eye view

The central concept remains **\*\*seeing or visual perspective\*\***.

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## ## 31. bird's-eye view

= a view from high above

\*\*鳥瞰圖；俯視圖；鳥瞰視角\*\*

### #### Examples

1. The tower offers a \*\*bird's-eye view\*\* of the city.

這座塔可以讓人\*\*鳥瞰整座城市\*\*。

2. The map gives a \*\*bird's-eye view\*\* of the area.

這張地圖提供該地區的\*\*俯視視角\*\*。

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## # Very common idiomatic extensions

## ## 32. open someone's eyes to something

= make someone realize or become aware of something

\*\*使某人認識到；讓某人大開眼界\*\*

### #### Examples

1. Travelling \*\*opened my eyes to\*\* different cultures.

旅行讓我\*\*真正認識到\*\*不同的文化。

2. The experience \*\*opened her eyes to\*\* the problem.

那次經歷讓她\*\*意識到\*\*這個問題。

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## ## 33. an eye-opener

= an experience or fact that makes someone realize something surprising or important

\*\*令人大開眼界的事；使人醒悟的經歷\*\*

### #### Examples

1. Working abroad was a real \*\*eye-opener\*\*.

在國外工作是一段真正\*\*大開眼界的經歷\*\*。

2. The report was an \*\*eye-opener\*\* for many people.

這份報告讓很多人\*\*大為醒悟\*\*。

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### ## 34. turn a blind eye

= deliberately ignore something wrong or unpleasant

**\*\*故意視而不見；睜一隻眼閉一隻眼\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. The manager **\*\*turned a blind eye\*\*** to the rule-breaking.  
經理對違規行為**\*\*故意視而不見\*\***。

2. We cannot **\*\*turn a blind eye\*\*** to bullying.  
我們不能對霸凌行為**\*\*視而不見\*\***。

This is highly idiomatic.

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### ## 35. keep your eyes open

### A. literally remain awake / keep eyes physically open

**\*\*睜著眼睛\*\***

### B. figuratively stay alert and observant

**\*\*提高警覺；留心\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. **\*\*Keep your eyes open\*\*** for anything unusual.  
**\*\*留意\*\***任何不尋常的情況。

2. You need to **\*\*keep your eyes open\*\*** in crowded places.  
在擁擠的地方你需要**\*\*提高警覺\*\***。

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### ## 36. have eyes in the back of your head

= seem able to notice everything happening around you

**\*\*眼觀四面；彷彿後腦也長了眼睛\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. Teachers need **\*\*eyes in the back of their heads\*\***.

老師簡直需要**\*\*眼觀四面\*\***。

2. My mother seemed to have **\*\*eyes in the back of her head\*\***.

我媽媽好像什麼都能**\*\*注意到\*\***。

Idiomatic and informal.

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### ## 37. feast your eyes on something

= look at something attractive with great pleasure

**\*\*盡情欣賞；大飽眼福\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. **\*\*Feast your eyes on\*\*** this beautiful view.

好好**\*\*欣賞這片美景\*\***吧。

2. Visitors can **\*\*feast their eyes on\*\*** hundreds of paintings.

遊客可以**\*\*盡情欣賞\*\***數百幅畫作。

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### ## 38. easy on the eyes

= visually pleasant or attractive

**\*\*賞心悅目的；看起來舒服的\*\***

#### ### Examples

1. The new design is simple and **\*\*easy on the eyes\*\***.

新設計簡潔而且**\*\*賞心悅目\*\***。

2. The colour scheme is very **\*\*easy on the eyes\*\***.

這套配色看起來非常**\*\*舒服\*\***。

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### ## 39. have eyes for someone

= be romantically interested in someone, often exclusively

**\*\*對某人有意思；鍾情於某人\*\***

### ### Examples

1. He only \*\*has eyes for her\*\*.  
他眼裡\*\*只有她一個人\*\*。
2. She clearly \*\*has eyes for\*\* her new colleague.  
她顯然\*\*對新同事有意思\*\*。

Idiomatic and informal.

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### ## 40. more than meets the eye

= more complicated or important than it first appears  
\*\*事情不像表面那麼簡單；另有內情\*\*

### ### Examples

1. There is \*\*more to this problem than meets the eye\*\*.  
這個問題\*\*比表面看起來更複雜\*\*。
2. The situation has \*\*more to it than meets the eye\*\*.  
這件事\*\*另有內情\*\*。

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### # Word-family extensions

### ## 41. eyed

Common as a combining form:

- \* blue-eyed 藍眼睛的
- \* brown-eyed 棕色眼睛的
- \* wide-eyed 睜大眼睛的 / 天真驚訝的
- \* sharp-eyed 眼光敏銳的
- \* keen-eyed 目光敏銳的

### ### Example

She is a \*\*sharp-eyed observer\*\*.  
她是一位\*\*觀察敏銳的人\*\*。

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## 42. wide-eyed

### A. with eyes opened wide

\*\*睜大眼睛的\*\*

### B. innocent, amazed, or inexperienced

\*\*天真驚訝的；涉世未深的\*\*

### Examples

1. The children stared **wide-eyed** at the fireworks.

孩子們**睜大眼睛**看著煙火。

2. He arrived in the city as a **wide-eyed teenager**.

他還是個**天真懵懂的少年**時來到這座城市。

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## 43. eyed — verb inflection

From **eye** as a verb:

\* eye

\* eyes

\* eyed

\* eyeing / eying

Example:

She **eyed** the last piece of cake.

她**盯著**最後一塊蛋糕看。

Both **eyeing** and **eying** occur, but **eyeing** is generally safer for learners.

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# Meaning map

The semantic network of **eye** develops from:

**physical organ of sight**

→ **ability to see**

→ **act/direction of looking**

→ **attention**

→ **observation and judgment**

→ **personal viewpoint**

→ **public attention**

A separate shape-based branch develops from:

**physical eye shape**

→ **needle eye**

→ **fastening eye**

→ **storm eye**

→ **potato eye**

This makes **eye** a particularly rich polysemous word.

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## # Essential contrasts

### ## eye vs eyesight

**eye**

can mean the physical organ or, figuratively, visual/perceptual ability.

**eyesight**

specifically means **視力**.

\* My **eyesight** is getting worse.

\* I have poor **eyesight**.

For formal discussion of visual ability, **eyesight** is usually clearer.

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### ## eye vs look

**eye** as a noun can mean a person's gaze or perceptual ability.

**look** often means:

\* an act of looking

\* appearance

Compare:

\* She has **an eye for detail**.

她善於發現細節。

\* She took \*\*a look at\*\* the document.  
她看了一下文件。

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### ## eye vs vision

\*\*vision\*\* may mean:

- \* eyesight
- \* ability to imagine the future
- \* a mental image

\*\*eye\*\* more strongly relates to:

- \* actual seeing
- \* looking
- \* visual judgment
- \* attention

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### ## eye vs view

\*\*eye\*\* can represent the observer or perspective.

\*\*view\*\* is more directly:

- \* what can be seen
- \* an opinion or perspective

Compare:

\* through the \*\*eyes\*\* of a child  
從孩子的角度

\* from the child's \*\*point of view\*\*  
從孩子的觀點

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### # Passage recap

> “She also had \*\*a sharp eye for potential\*\*.”

Here:

**\*\*eye\*\*** = ability to notice, recognize, and judge something well

Best Traditional Chinese renderings:

\* **\*\*眼光\*\***

\* **\*\*觀察力\*\***

\* **\*\*識人眼光\*\***

So:

**\*\*a sharp eye for potential\*\***

= **\*\*很善於看出別人的潛力\*\***

= **\*\*對他人的潛力有敏銳的眼光\*\***

### MCQ-ready meaning

**\*\*eye\*\*** in **\*\*“a sharp eye for potential”\*\***

= **\*\*ability to notice or judge something\*\***

**\*\*眼光；辨識能力；觀察力\*\***

It does **\*\*not\*\*** simply mean the physical **\*\*眼睛\*\***.